Ian Douglas

Staff Platform Engineer | Infrastructure Architect

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Platform architect with 12+ years delivering infrastructure-as-product, automation tooling, and self-service platforms across AWS, Azure, and GCP. Specializes in Kubernetes, zero-trust architecture, and identity infrastructure. Builds hardened platforms that unlock developer velocity at enterprise scale.

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

Platform & Systems: Self-Managed Kubernetes (Control Plane, etcd, Bare-Metal), Managed K8s (EKS, AKS, GKE), Software-Defined Infrastructure, Linux Internals, Hybrid/Multi-Cloud (AWS, Azure, GCP)

Software & Automation: Go (Golang), Python (Pandas, Boto3), API-Driven Automation, Terraform at scale, GitOps (ArgoCD, Flux CD), CI/CD (GitHub Actions, GitLab Pipelines), Agentic Workflows (Claude Code, Codex), Bash, PowerShell

Security & Governance: HashiCorp Vault (PKI), Policy-as-Code (OPA), Zero Trust Architecture, Identity Management (Azure Entra ID, AWS IAM/PIM), Compliance Hardening

Observability & Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Distributed Logging (Fluentd, Elasticsearch), PostgreSQL, MSSQL, High-Throughput Data Pipelines

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The Motley Fool | Alexandria, VA (Remote)

Senior Platform Engineer | 04/2026 – Present

- **Migration Automation:** Engineered reusable Python tooling that mechanized the migration of ~200 repositories from legacy Jenkins pipelines to GitHub Actions, saving months of manual engineering effort.
- **Secrets Migration:** Automated the transfer of pipeline secrets from AWS Secrets Manager to dotenvx within the same toolchain, eliminating hand-copied credentials across every cutover.
- **AI-Accelerated Development:** Built the migration toolchain with Claude Code agentic workflows, delivering production-grade automation in a fraction of the usual development time.
- **Cloud Infrastructure:** Operate production AWS and Kubernetes infrastructure supporting the company's engineering organization.

Kings Mountain Security | Palo Alto, CA (Remote)

Staff Engineer & Security Architect | 01/2025 – Present

- **Zero Trust Architecture:** Co-founded a zero-trust specialized security consultancy delivering 'Zero Trust Capability Packages' via tactical, high-impact engagements.
- **Compliance Automation:** Developing progressive 'Security-as-Code' modules to automate DoD Zero Trust compliance within modern infrastructure lifecycles.
- **Secure CI/CD:** Engineering high-integrity, containerized CI/CD pipelines to ensure secure, repeatable deployments.

FlowDelta Trading | Boulder, CO (Remote)

Senior Software Engineer (Python/Data) | 01/2025 – 04/2026

- **Backtesting Platform:** Developed a proprietary, multi-horizon analysis platform for a boutique trading desk, enabling rapid backtesting and validation of medium-frequency algorithms.
- **Data-Intensive Systems:** Engineered a vectorized Monte Carlo simulation engine to perform multi-dimensional parameter grid sweeps, optimizing data throughput for large-scale strategy stress-testing.

ZagTech | San Jose, CA (Remote)

Senior Platform Engineer | 04/2024 – 12/2024

- **Commercial Platform:** Engineered a proprietary Kubernetes platform commercialized across multiple enterprise clients; codebase served as a primary value driver for the firm's subsequent acquisition.
- **Golden Path Modules:** Architected modular Terraform libraries for AKS and VMSS, establishing a "Golden Path" for compliant, self-service infrastructure provisioning.
- **Developer Experience (DevEx):** Built Go and Python tooling to automate GitOps workflows, increasing deployment velocity while reducing change failure rates.

Invitae Biosciences | San Francisco, CA (Remote)

Senior Platform Engineer | 07/2023 – 04/2024

- **Internal Developer Platform (IDP):** Engineered a self-service IDP for genetics researchers and software engineers, abstracting complex compute requirements for petabyte-scale genomics workloads as part of a five-person team.
- **Reliability Engineering:** Executed zero-downtime Kubernetes upgrades and complex stateful workload migrations, maintaining high availability for critical research data.
- **Secrets Management Architecture:** Designed an enterprise-grade secrets management solution utilizing SOPS, AWS KMS, and Shamir Sharding to enforce "least privilege" access programmatically.
- **Cluster Hardening:** Developed custom auditing tools to enforce CIS benchmarks and Day Zero hardening across all cluster deployments.

Pearson | London, UK (Remote)

Senior Cloud Platforms Engineer | 09/2019 – 08/2021

- **GitOps Platform:** Developed and operated Internal Developer Platforms (IDP) via self-hosted Kubernetes in a continuous delivery (CI/CD) GitOps model.

- **Custom Kubernetes Operators:** Engineered a self-managed Kubernetes ecosystem on EC2, developing custom Go-based operators to abstract and orchestrate AWS services.
- **Observability Pipeline:** Developed a scalable, distributed log aggregation system using Fluentd, Python, and AWS Lambda, processing massive log volumes into Elasticsearch for real-time analysis.

Stanford University | Palo Alto, CA

DevOps Engineer & Security Architect | 12/2015 – 09/2019

- **Identity Modernization:** Partnered with Infrastructure teams to re-architect legacy Identity services (LDAP/Kerberos) into containerized, cloud-native workloads running on self-hosted Kubernetes.
- **Cloud-Native Directory:** Authored the reference implementation for a cloud-resident Active Directory system leveraging IPv6 and IPsec mesh networking for secure, boundary-less access.
- **Secrets Infrastructure:** Managed multi-tenant HashiCorp Vault clusters to provide automated PKI, authentication proxies, and encryption as part of a three-person team.

Marvel Heroes (Gazillion Entertainment) | Foster City, CA

DevOps Engineer | 06/2014 – 12/2015

- **High-Concurrency Scaling:** Scaled infrastructure for a flagship MMO with 40k+ DAU; developed cluster ops tools in PowerShell and SQL Server Management Objects (SMO) to automate database operations and reduce service drain times by 93%.
- **Release Operations:** Supported high-velocity weekly production releases while maintaining system reliability.

Two Sigma | New York, NY

Systems Engineer | 05/2012 – 06/2014

- **Fleet Management:** Automated bare-metal provisioning and configuration management for high-performance servers critical to research and trading operations.
- **Lifecycle Automation:** Orchestrated zero-touch deployment and lifecycle operations of 1,000+ secure workstations firm-wide.

Columbia University | New York, NY

Systems Engineer | 06/2010 – 05/2012

- **Infrastructure Operations:** Ran databases, ESX, storage, and VM infrastructure supporting Columbia's 22 libraries.

EDUCATION

University of Denver | Denver, CO

Bachelor of Arts (BA), Double Major: Mathematics & Philosophy

- **Mathematics:** Completed Bachelor of Science curriculum including grad-level coursework.

- **Philosophy:** Specialized in Formal Logic and Epistemology.